

Chapter 1

Numbers

1 Introduction

First of all, thank you for reading this guide!

This guide serves as a standalone guide to the basics of mathematics, starting with numbers. It assumes you know how to perform the four basic operations (addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division, though there will be a quick passthrough); everything else will be covered in full.

Before we dive into all of the goodies maths has to offer, however, we should talk about the most basic building blocks of mathematics, without which nothing in our modern world (not just the world of mathematics) could function - numbers.

In this chapter, we will explore where numbers came from, what people used to do with them, how people counted before we had supercomputers in our pockets, and most importantly, what we can now do with them.

2 Numbers - The Building Blocks of Mathematics